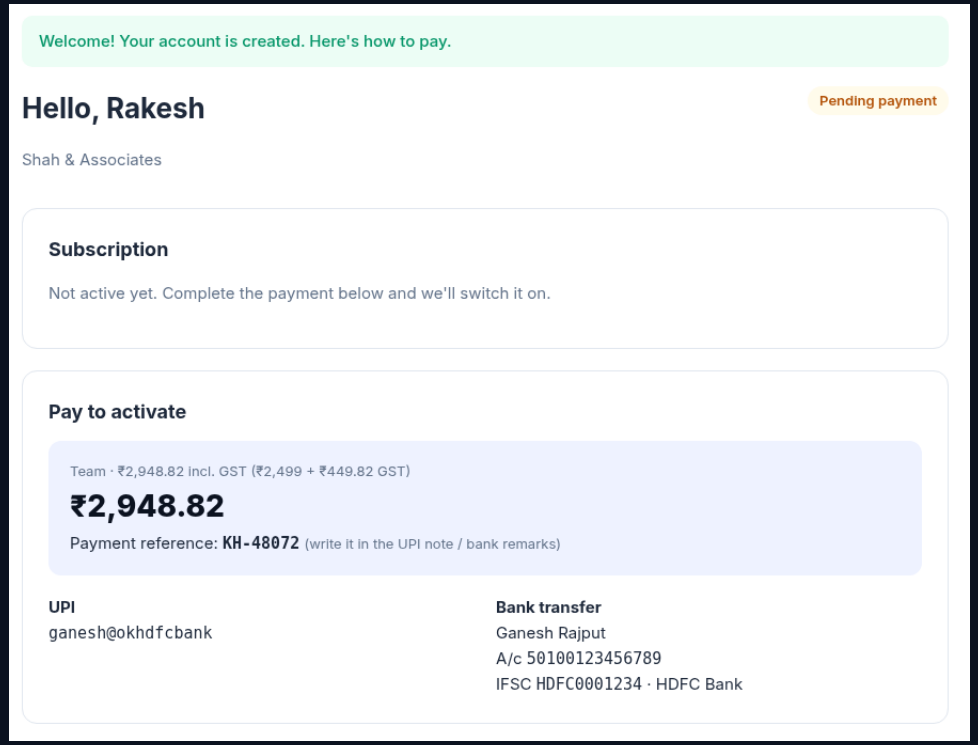
INTERNAL · RUNBOOK V2 · 5 NOV 2026

Run it. Sell it. Operate it.

The product, the new licence system (website, admin panel, signed licences) and how a CA firm goes from sign-up to working offline.



Ganesh Rajput · KnowledgeHub AI

WHAT'S NEW SINCE V1

The business side is built

A CA firm can now find you, sign up, pay and be activated, without you touching the database.

01

Customer website

Pricing from your plans, register, pay instructions, 'I have paid', download, computers, team, password.

02

Admin panel

Plans & prices, firms, payment confirmation, trials, blocks, logins, monthly CSV, activity log.

03

Signed licences

App login API returns a 24-hour licence signed with your private key. Can't be faked or moved to another PC.

04

Pricing research

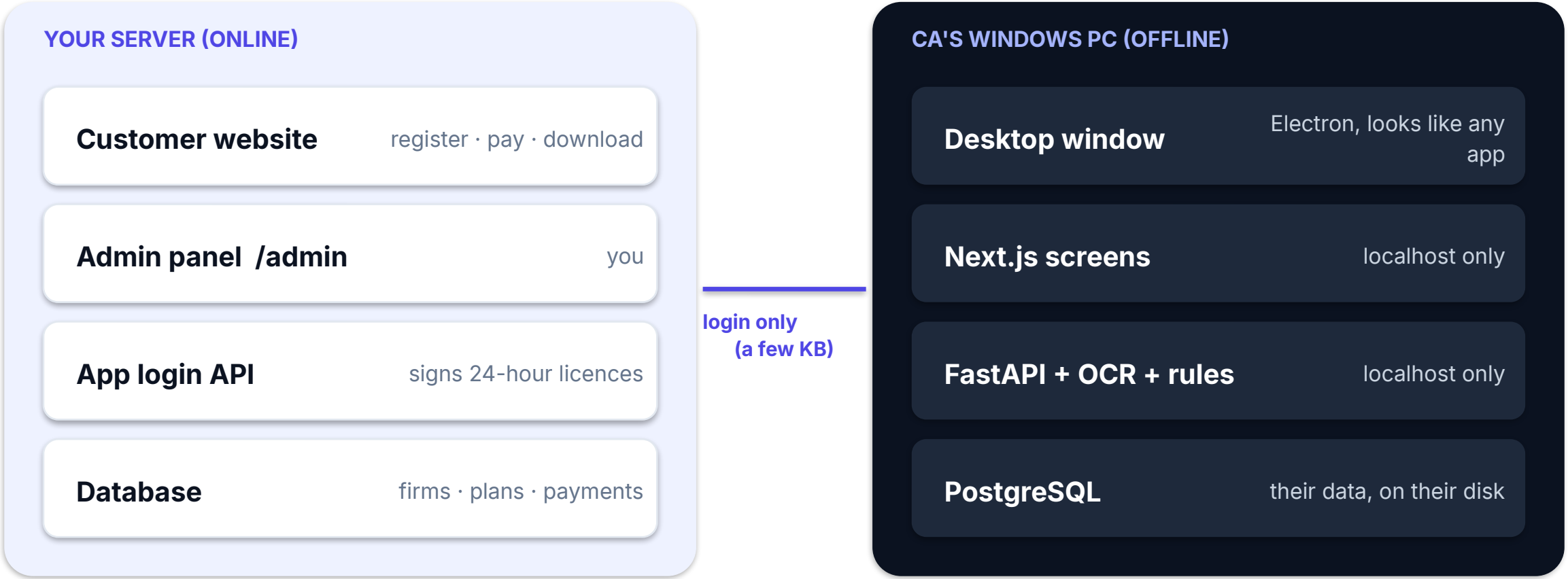
What CA software costs in India, how it's licensed, and suggested starting plans.

Not yet: the desktop app doesn't check the licence yet, and there is no Windows installer. Sell pilots, not self-service, until Phases 2–3 are done.

THE WHOLE SYSTEM

Two parts: your server, their computer

Client documents never leave the CA's office. Only the login goes over the internet.



HOW A 'WEBSITE' RUNS OFFLINE

Same app you run today, packaged for Windows

You already run it on localhost: web :3000, API :8001, Postgres. The installer does the same on their PC.

Web technology ≠ internet

VS Code, Slack and WhatsApp Desktop are web screens inside a desktop window.

Everything listens on localhost only

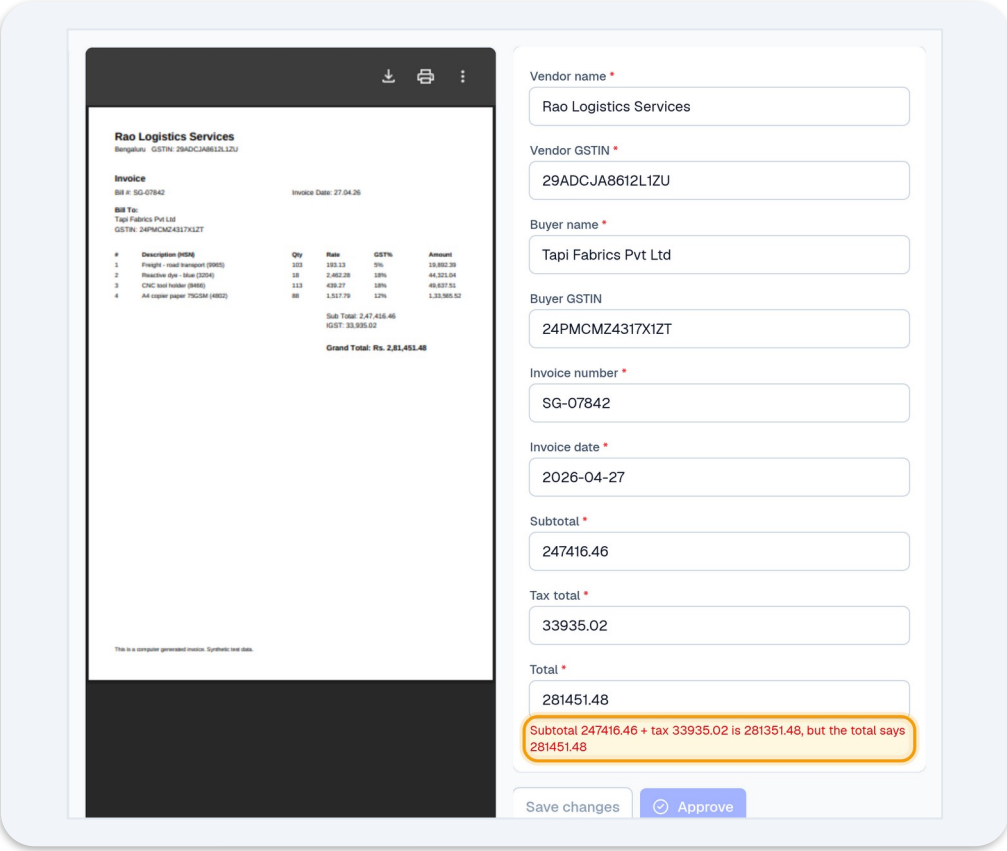
Nobody else on their network or the internet can reach it.

One double-click starts it all

Database → API → window; shuts down cleanly on exit.

Internet only at login

A few seconds when the app opens; then up to 24 hours offline.



RUN IT

Commands you need

Product app and licence server run side by side on your machine.

Task	Command / address
Product app (first time)	./setup.sh
Product app (daily)	./run.sh → web :3000 · API :8001
Licence server (first time)	cd licensing · alembic upgrade head · python -m app.cli create-admin you@... · python -m app.cli generate-keys
Licence server (daily)	cd licensing · .venv/bin/uvicorn app.main:app --port 8002
Website / admin	http://localhost:8002 · http://localhost:8002/admin
Tests	backend: 237 tests · licensing: 66 tests (python -m pytest)

Guard the signing key: licensing/keys/lease_private.pem creates licences. Never commit it; back it up offline.

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

From sign-up to working, in five steps

Manual payments for now: you confirm every payment in the admin panel.

01

Register

Customer signs up on your website and picks a plan. Firm is Pending payment.

02

Pay

Their account shows the amount incl. GST, your UPI / bank details and a KH- reference.

03

I have paid

They enter the UTR. It appears on your admin dashboard.

04

You activate

Check the UTR in your bank app → Check & activate → Record payment.

05

Download & log in

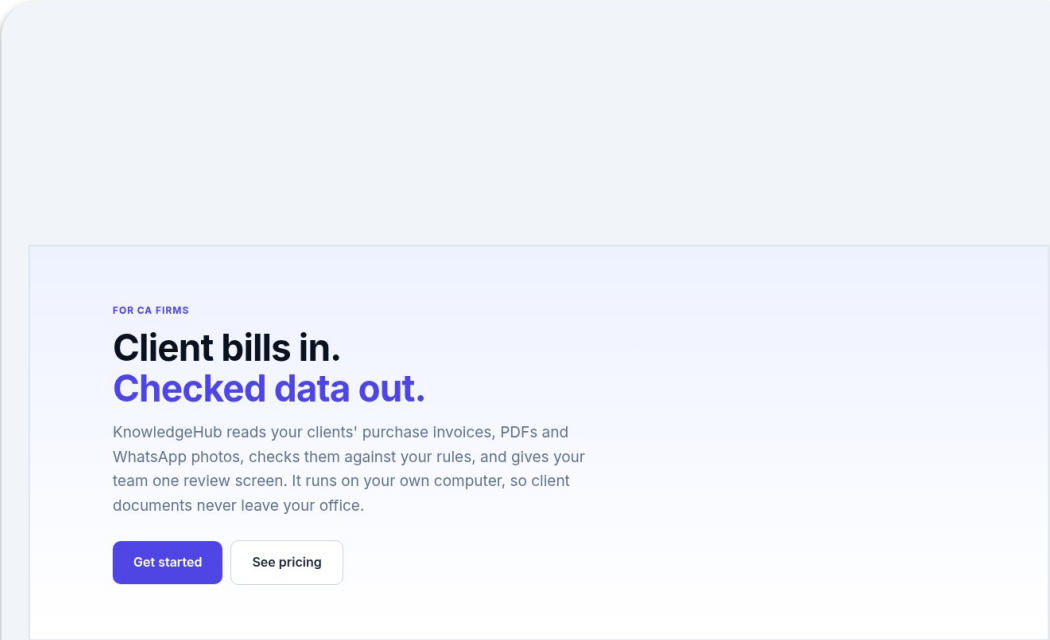
Download button appears. The app logs in with the same email and password.

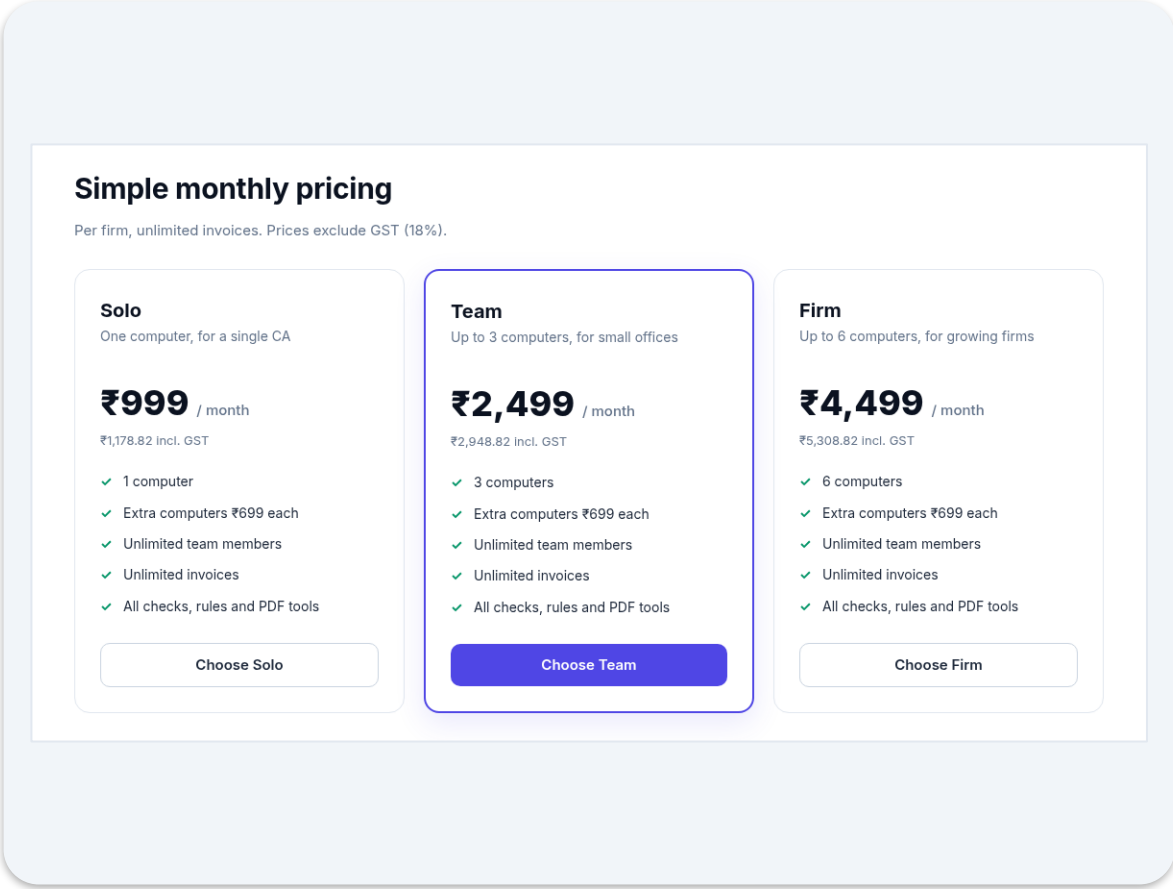
Your only job: step 4. Check the UTR in your bank / UPI app before you click Record payment.

STEP 1 · WEBSITE

Your shop window

Pricing cards come live from Admin → Plans & prices.

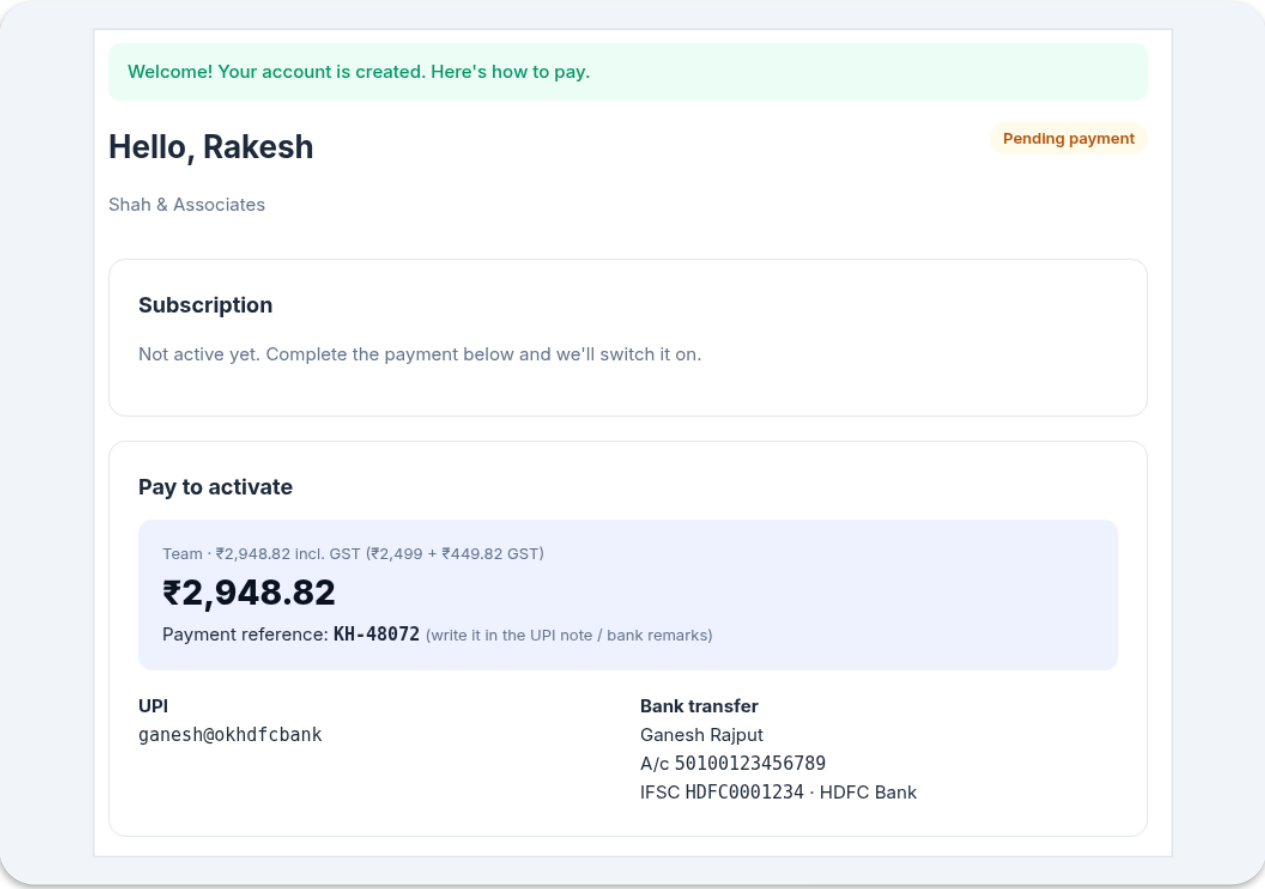




STEPS 2–3 · PAYMENT

They see exactly what to pay

Amount incl. GST, your UPI and bank details, their KH- reference, and an 'I have paid' form.



KH- reference

Asks them to put it in the UPI note / bank remarks, so you can match the money.

I have paid

Amount, UPI or bank, UTR and date. Max 3 open reports per firm.

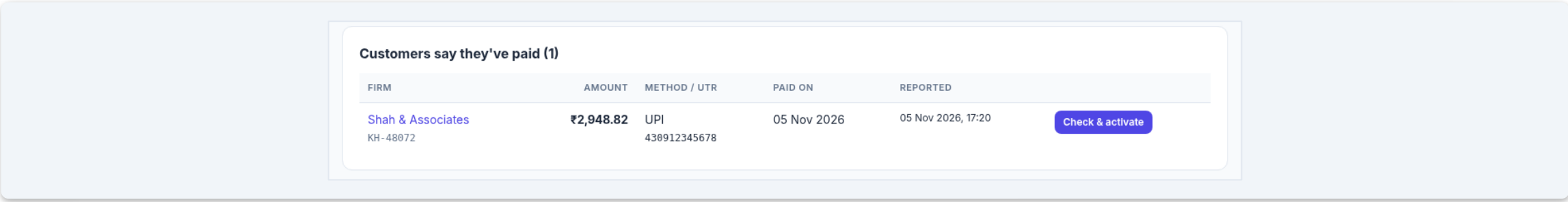
Set your details once

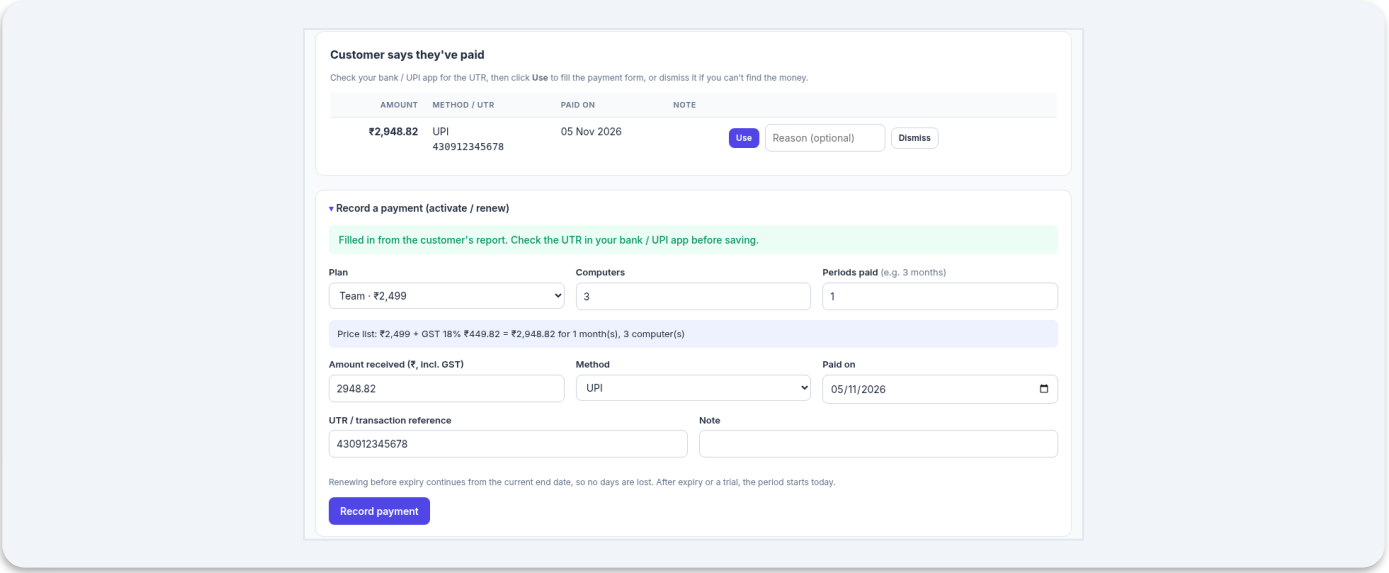
Admin → Settings → How customers pay you.

STEP 4 · YOU ACTIVATE

Check the money, then one click

Reports show on the dashboard; the payment form is filled in from the customer's report.





Price list shown

Lower amounts are allowed (discounts) but noted in the log.

Renewals never lose days

Early renewal continues from the end date.

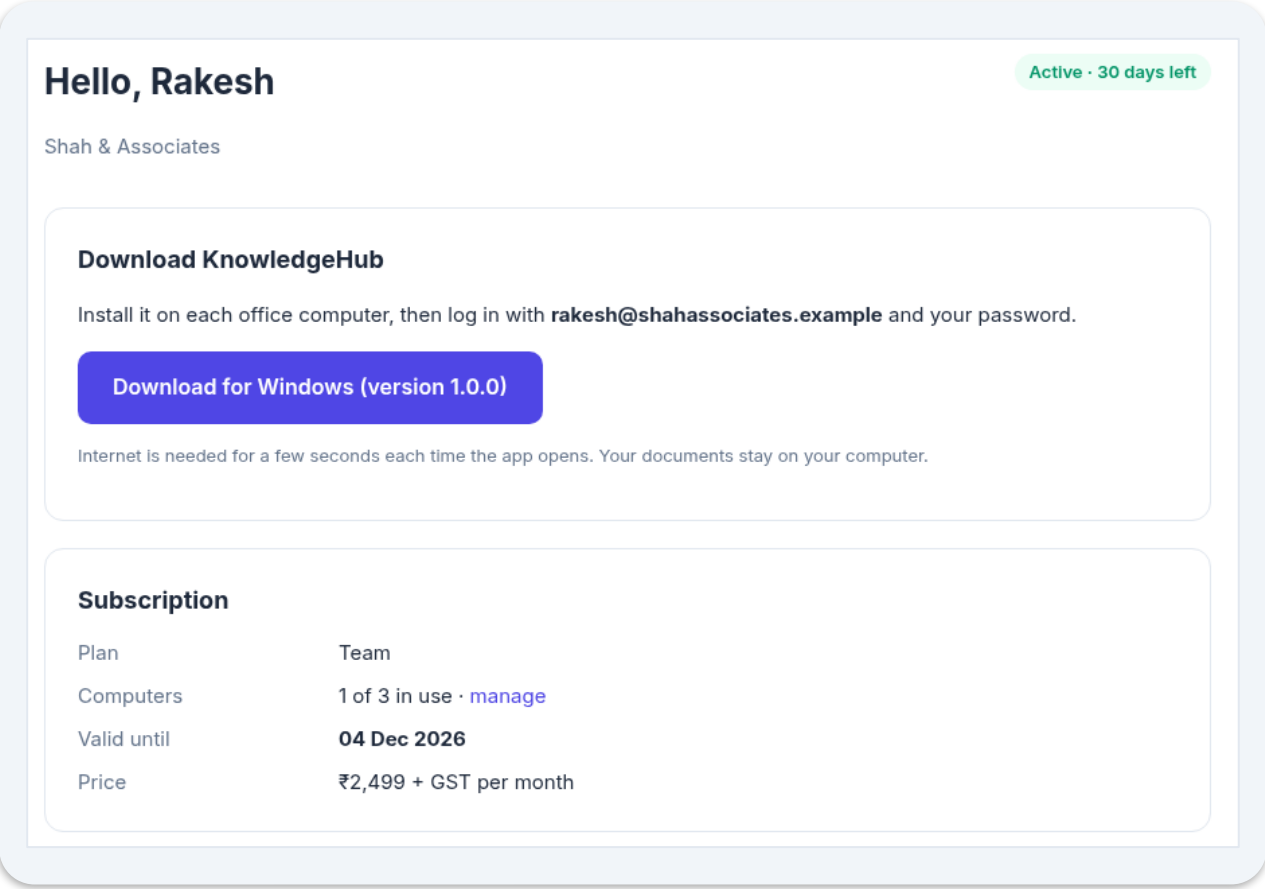
Can't find the money?

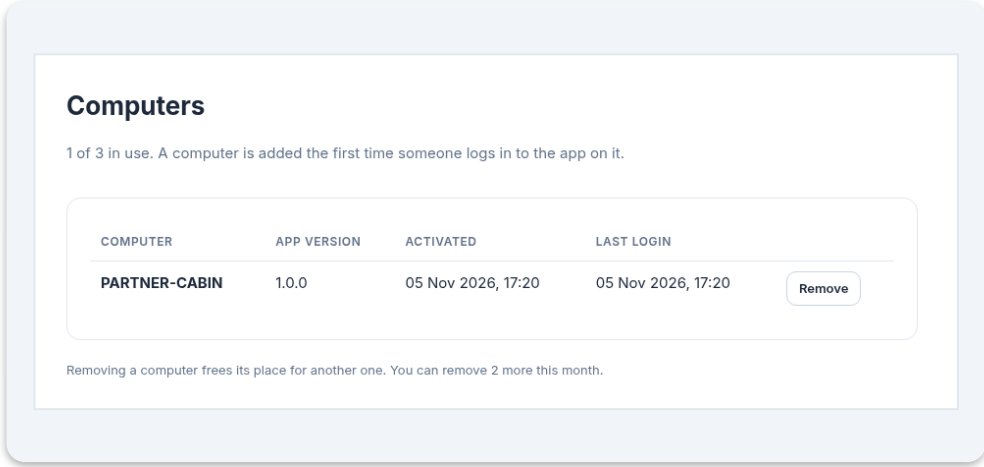
Dismiss the report with a reason.

STEP 5 · DOWNLOAD & LOG IN

Active: download appears, computers fill up

Each computer takes a seat the first time someone logs in to the app on it.





Download link

Admin → Settings → Desktop app. Shown only to active firms.

Seats

Customers remove old computers themselves (2 per month).

ADMIN PANEL

Everyday tasks: where to click

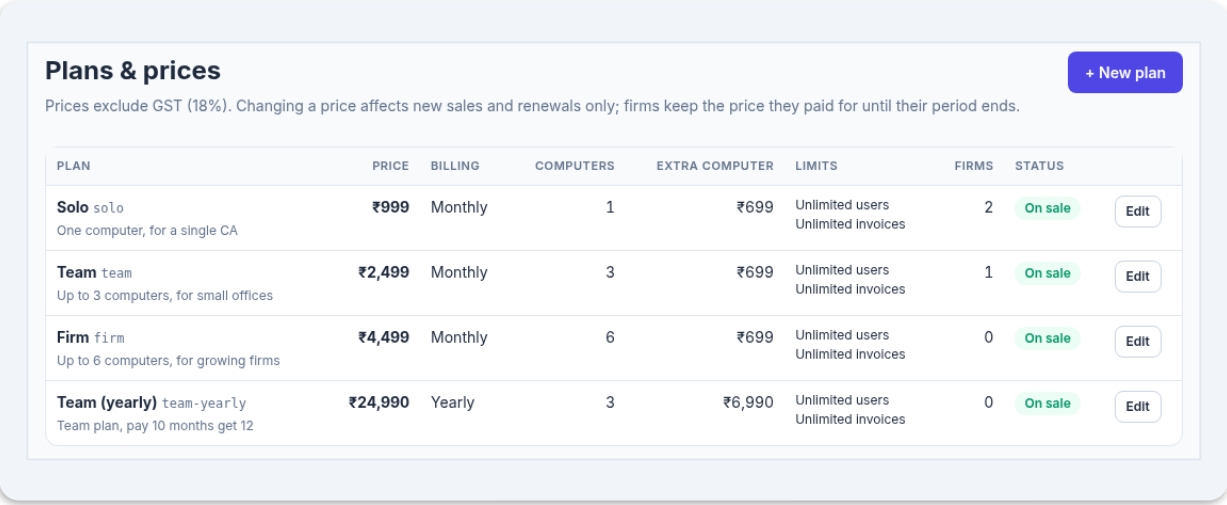
http://your-domain/admin

I want to…	Where
Activate a firm after payment	Dashboard → Customers say they've paid → Check & activate → Record payment
Firm paid without reporting it	Firms → firm → Record a payment (price-list total is pre-filled)
Renew	Same form. Before expiry it continues from the end date; after expiry it starts today
Change a price / plan	Plans & prices → Edit. Existing firms keep the price they paid
Private deal	New plan with 'Show on website' unticked
Trial for a pilot	Firm → Start a free trial (days, computers)
Goodwill days / fix a mistake	Firm → Adjust end date or computers (reason required)
Customer forgot password	Firm → Logins → Set new password (also unlocks the account)
New PC but all seats used	Customer removes one in My account → Computers, or you remove it on the firm page
Licence misuse	Firm → Block firm, or block a single computer
Monthly figures for your CA	Payments → month → Download CSV
UPI, bank, GST %, grace days, download link	Settings

PLANS & PRICING

What the market charges, and where we start

Research 5 Nov 2026 (docs/CA-pricing-research.md). Prices excl. GST.



Plans & prices

Prices exclude GST (18%). Changing a price affects new sales and renewals only; firms keep the price they paid for until their period ends.

+ New plan

PLAN	PRICE	BILLING	COMPUTERS	EXTRA COMPUTER	LIMITS	FIRMS	STATUS	
Solo solo One computer, for a single CA	₹999	Monthly	1	₹699	Unlimited users Unlimited invoices	2	On sale	Edit
Team team Up to 3 computers, for small offices	₹2,499	Monthly	3	₹699	Unlimited users Unlimited invoices	1	On sale	Edit
Firm firm Up to 6 computers, for growing firms	₹4,499	Monthly	6	₹699	Unlimited users Unlimited invoices	0	On sale	Edit
Team (yearly) team-yearly Team plan, pay 10 months get 12	₹24,990	Yearly	3	₹6,990	Unlimited users Unlimited invoices	0	On sale	Edit

Suggested start: Solo ₹999/mo (1 PC) · Team ₹2,499 (3 PCs) · Firm ₹4,499 (6 PCs) · extra PC ₹699 · yearly = 10 months.

Our 24-hour online login is stricter than anything CAs use today: expect questions.

Vyapar TaxOne (was Suvit)
₹7,000/year, one plan, 7-day trial

Tally
Silver ₹22,500 + ₹4,500/yr · Gold ₹67,500 · rent ₹750/mo

Tally 'Docs by Ira' OCR
₹200 per 100 pages

Small firms
₹5,000–25,000 a year per product; trials 7–30 days

LICENCE RULES

What the app will be told at login

Every refusal comes with a message ready to show the customer.

Customer sees	Code	What you do
Wrong email or password	invalid_credentials	Check spelling; reset password in the firm's Logins panel
Too many wrong passwords	locked	Wait 15 minutes, or set a new password (unlocks)
Subscription isn't active yet	no_subscription	Confirm their payment
Subscription ended on …	expired	Record the renewal payment
All computers in use	computer_limit	Remove an old computer, or sell extra computers
Account / computer blocked	firm_blocked / computer_blocked	Unblock if resolved
Please install the latest version	update_required	Send the download link

Licence lasts 24 hours (Settings) and never beyond the subscription end + grace days. Kept in memory only.

GO-LIVE CHECKLIST

Before the first real customer

Licence server on the internet, with HTTPS.

- [ ] Domain + small VPS (₹1–2k/month) with HTTPS (e.g. Caddy)
- [ ] Licence server .env: real DATABASE_URL, COOKIE_SECURE=true, PUBLIC_URL=https://your-domain
- [ ] Run uvicorn with --proxy-headers and a single worker
- [ ] generate-keys on the server; back up keys/lease_private.pem offline; keep the public key for the app
- [ ] Strong admin password (create-admin); daily database backup
- [ ] Admin → Settings: UPI ID, bank details, GSTIN, support email/phone, grace days
- [ ] Admin → Plans & prices: your real plans
- [ ] Admin → Settings → Desktop app: download link + version (once the installer exists)

STATUS

Done, not yet, next

Ship in this order; reorder the product work by what CA firms say.

DONE

- Product: extraction, rules per client, review & audit, PDF tools, Q&A, Excel export
- Licence server: customer website, admin panel, manual payments, signed 24-hour licences
- Pricing research and suggested plans
- Demo kit v1 (deck, overview, playbook)

NOT YET

- Licence check inside the desktop app (app doesn't refuse to run yet)
- Windows installer (Electron + bundled Postgres, Nuitka-compiled API)
- Password-reset emails, Razorpay, GST invoices for your sales
- Tally export, GSTR-2B reconciliation, line-item GST checks

NEXT

Phase 2 Licence check in the app: login screen, lease kept in memory, every API call checked

Phase 3 Windows installer: one click, offline, auto-update, daily backups

Phase 4 Code signing, Razorpay auto-activation, GST invoices

Product Tax breakdown → Tally export → GSTR-2B, ordered by what CA firms say